concerned, he immediately directed senior officials in the PMO to find a solution which would stop these attacks and also added that the violators should be subject to the strictest punishment.

This is how, the Ordinance to amend the Epidemic Diseases Act, 1897 which would provide for making such acts of violence cognizable and non-bailable offences was introduced. It would also provide compensation for injury to healthcare service personnel or for damage or loss to property in which these personnel had direct interest in. In the Union Cabinet meeting held on 22 April, promulgation of this Ordinance would be approved, immediately after which the president would give his assent.[21]

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In an attempt to make the states more financially secure, during his video call with the chief ministers on 2 April, the prime minister assured the quick release of the Centre's share of the first instalment of the State Disaster Risk Management Fund. After his directions, the Union home minister Amit Shah approved the release of ₹11,092 crore and immediately disbursed them to the states, providing the much-needed financial relief to the states.[22] Unfortunately, many states failed to use these funds to relieve the plight of the migrants.

To specifically cater to the urgent requirements of a pandemic, the prime minister proposed to set up a separate public charitable relief trust fund which would accept voluntary donations from Indian citizens called the Prime Minister's Citizen Assistance and Relief in Emergency Situations Fund (PM CARES). The trust would be chaired by the prime minister and include three ministers from the Union Cabinet who hold the three most important portfolios: Home, Defence and Finance, and would be audited by an independent auditor. As soon as the fund was announced, donations started pouring in from citizens who wanted to show their solidarity with the prime minister's efforts.[23]

Donations to the tune of ₹3,000 crore would be collected in 2020 and several essentials in critical times during the pandemic years would be provided for by this fund.[24] However, it became mired in controversy after sections of the Opposition criticized the opacity of it. The fund was not covered under the Right to Information (RTI) Act since it did not qualify as a government or public authority and received donations which were